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Hiring Team
Investment Banking Division

Re: Application for the 2027 Investment Banking Summer Analyst Programme — London

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the 2027 Investment Banking Summer Analyst Programme in London, with a particular interest in M&A. I am a BSc Finance student at the London School of Economics, graduating in June 2028, currently predicted a First after a Year 1 average of 72%.

Your company interests me because the firm has built its advisory business without a balance sheet behind it, which means the advice has had to be the product. I attended your London insight afternoon in March, where an associate in the industrials team described walking a client away from a deal the firm would have been paid to complete that decision, and the fact she volunteered it to a room of students, told me more than any values page. Outside my degree I set up and run a weekly numeracy session for GCSE students in Tower Hamlets, which has taken six students through to a grade 5 or above, and I publish an equity research note each term for a 200-member society. Both taught me to take ownership, develop ideas independently and turn them into something others can engage with.

My recent internships taught me to research a company and its sector, build the valuation behind it, and turn both into materials a client actually reads. At Calderwood Partners this summer I built a trading comparables analysis of twelve UK business services companies that became the benchmarking section of a live sell-side pitch, and drafted two teasers for a £40m carve-out, condensing a 30-page information pack into the summary used for first-round outreach. At Harlow & Vance I completed a valuation case study on a mid-market manufacturer and defended the assumptions to three directors in a 15-minute Q&A. Earlier, at Meridian Wealth Advisers, I reconciled more than 300 portfolio statements against custodian records and found fourteen discrepancies that went to compliance. I also work in Spanish at an intermediate level.

I hold two roles alongside my degree. As an equity research analyst at the LSE Investment Society I publish one note per term, and the November note was selected as the society's stock pick. As vice-captain of the Men's 2nd XI I organise a squad of twenty across a fixture list set by the league. Both mean delivering to a calendar set with other people, alongside a full degree.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application with the team, and thank you for taking the time to consider it.

Yours faithfully,

Graham Harris